

Eli Lilly and Company

Overview

Eli Lilly and Company is a **Large Public** firm based in **Indianapolis, IN**. They perform **Biopharmaceutical research, development, and manufacturing** for **Global patients with chronic conditions**.

Heavy investment in AI-driven drug discovery and clinical trial expansion aligns directly with UNC's strength in biomedical informatics and health data research.

Markus Saba is the best avenue for partnership because Retired Eli Lilly senior executive with deep institutional knowledge of Lilly's internal operations and existing academic credibility within UNC's health business ecosystem.

Basic Company Information

- **Name, Company Location:** Eli Lilly and Company, Indianapolis, IN
- **Company Website URL:** lilly.com
- **Company Type, Company Size:** Public, Large (approx. 50,000 employees)

Company Type

- **IPO?** Yes (NYSE: LLY) — 1952

Company Size

- **Large:** 50,000+

UNC Connection

- **UNC Alum:** Markus Saba — Retired Eli Lilly Senior Executive; Professor of the Practice of Marketing / Executive Director, Center for the Business of Health at UNC
- **Donation History:** Long history of philanthropic support in healthcare. Specific UNC donation history to be verified via UNC Office of Development.

Talking Points

- **AI-Driven Drug Discovery:** Actively integrating generative AI for biologic design via 2026 collaboration with Chai Discovery and open-source Lilly TuneLab initiative, providing models trained on proprietary research data to academic partners. [1]

- **Informatics Research Synergy:** UNC's biomedical informatics infrastructure, including the NC TraCS Institute, provides scalable data management and analytics platforms capable of supporting complex R&D workflows. [2]
- **Clinical Trial Infrastructure:** UNC Health utilizes decentralized and hybrid trial models to improve patient access and trial recruitment efficiency, aligning with biopharmaceutical needs for faster study execution. [3]
- **Computational Biology Capabilities:** UNC maintains advanced HPC resources and core facilities for processing large-scale genomic and proteomic datasets, essential for fast design-build-test-learn cycles. [4]
- **Talent Development:** Eli Lilly maintains a formal internship and corporate hiring program focused on technical and data-driven roles, providing a direct pipeline for UNC data science and biomedical informatics graduates. [5]

References

- Chai Discovery & Eli Lilly Partnership. (2026). *AI Biologics Design*. <https://intuitionlabs.ai/pdfs/ai-biologics-design-chai-discovery-eli-lilly-partnership.pdf>
- Desai, S., & Motoyama, Y.. (2015). *The Regional Environment in Indianapolis: Insights from High-Growth Companies*. SSRN Electronic Journal. <https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.2660938>